

Chenyu Bu

Curriculum Vitae | July 2026

Department of Philosophy
University of Texas, Austin
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EDUCATION

University of Texas at Austin 2021 –
Ph.D. in Philosophy (ABD)
Dissertation: *Objects, Structures, and Abstraction*
Committee: Kathleen Higgins (co-chair), Jon Litland (co-chair),
Robbie Kubala, Josh Dever, James Buhler (Music)

University of Wisconsin–Madison 2017 – 2021
B.A. in Philosophy, Music Composition, Mathematics, *with Honors*

RESEARCH AREAS

AOS: Metaphysics, Aesthetics
AOC: Philosophy of Mathematics, Philosophy of Language, Philosophy of Logic

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

Music without Works: A Case for Compositional Ontology 2026
The Philosophical Quarterly (forthcoming).

Schopenhauerian Musical Formalism: Meaningfulness without Meaning 2023
Journal of Comparative Literature and Aesthetics 46 (4), 92-101.

Book Reviews

Daniel Albright, *Music's Monisms: Disarticulating Modernism* (2022) 2024
The British Journal of Aesthetics, 65 (4), 691-695

Tristan Grøtvedt Haze, *Meaning and Metaphysical Necessity* (2022) 2023
Review of Metaphysics 77 (2), 351-353.

WORKS IN PROGRESS

Under Review

A paper on musical formalism, movement, and meaning

In Preparation

A paper developing a general theory of generativism
A paper arguing for a top-down structuralist approach to essences
A paper presenting and defending a trifold (platonist) conception of musical ontology
A paper on abstraction and identity without identification
A paper on the nature of aesthetic form

Collaborative Projects

Generative Ecologies: Tweaks, Leaps, and Blocks
Enacted Metaphor and Tacit Knowledge Transmission

SELECTED TALKS

Conference Presentations (* = peer-reviewed; † = invited)

Yoneda Essence and Structural Identity		
<i>Defining the Formal Foundations of Intelligences</i> , [†]	Bloomington, IN	May 2026
Generating Structures: An Essentialist Account		
<i>2026 Henle Conference on Essentialism</i> , [*]	St. Louis, MO	March 2026
How to Stop Worrying and Embrace Musical Platonism		
<i>American Society for Aesthetics (ASA) Pacific Meeting</i> , [*]	Berkeley, CA	March 2026
<i>American Philosophical Association (APA) Pacific Meeting</i> , [*]	Chicago, IL	April 2026
Beyond the Given: Toward a General Theory of Generativism		
<i>APA Central Meeting</i> , [*]	Chicago, IL	February 2026
Toward a General Theory of Generativism		
<i>Metaphysical Mayhem</i> , [*]	New Brunswick, NJ	May 2025
Doing Away with Works: Let's Talk About <i>Music</i>		
<i>APA Central Meeting</i> [*] [virtual]		February 2025
Abstract Object and Platonic Inheritance		
<i>APA Eastern Meeting</i> ,	New York, NY	January 2025
Cohesion, Clarity, Closure: How Music Navigates the Wake of Tragedy		
<i>Performance Philosophy Biennial Conference</i> , [*]	Austin, TX	May 2024
Structuralism Made Simple via Morphisms		
<i>uAnalytiCon Annual International Conference</i> [*] [virtual]		May 2024
Musical Formalism Reconsidered: A Category-Theoretic Approach		
<i>ASA Eastern Meeting</i> , [*]	Philadelphia, PA	April 2024
Music as Meaningfulness Without Meaning: A Schopenhauerian Account		
<i>Jahrestagung der Schopenhauer-Forschungsstelle</i> [*] [virtual]		November 2023
<i>UT-Austin Graduate Colloquia Series</i> ,	Austin, TX	September 2022
In Defense of a Real Musical Platonism		
<i>ASA Rocky Mountain Meeting</i> , [*]	Santa Fe, NM	July 2023
An Inferentialist Account of <i>I</i>		
<i>Society for Philosophy in the Contemporary World Annual Meeting</i> , [*]	Fresno, CA	July 2023
Sound, Silence, and Sartrean Nothingness		
<i>Boston College Dianoia Publication Symposium</i> [†] [virtual]		July 2020
Commentaries		
Andrew Kania, "Justifying and Advancing the Explication of the Musical-Cover Concept," [†]	<i>ASA 83rd Annual Meeting</i> , Baltimore, MD	October 2025
Matthew Shields, "The Impossibility of Conceptual Abandonment," [†]	<i>APA Central Meeting</i> [virtual]	February 2025
Minseok Kim, "Way-Nominalism: An Ontological Ground for Non-Nominal Quantification," [†]	<i>APA Central Meeting</i> , New Orleans, LA	February 2024

ACADEMIC AWARDS	American Society for Aesthetics Dissertation Fellowship	2026-27
	Dean's Prestigious Supplement Fellowship, UT Austin	2026-27
	Fellow, Diverse Intelligences Summer Institute	2026
	University Graduate Continuing Fellowship, UT Austin	2025-26
	Humanities Research Awards, The Humanities Institute	2025-26
	Billy Bob Draeger Graduate Research Fellowship in the Humanities	2024-25
	Summer Graduate Fellowship, UT Austin	2024
	Professional Development Awards (*8), UT Austin	2023, 2024
	Irene H. Chayes Travel Grants (*3), ASA	2023, 2024, 2026
	Best Graduate Student Essay Prize, Center for Philosophical Studies	2023
	Summer Research Funds (*2), UT Graduate Studies	2023, 2024
	Top Paper of <i>Logos</i> Volume XVI, Cornell University	2020
TEACHING EXPERIENCE	Instructor of Record at University of Texas at Austin	
	Philosophy and Film	Spring 2025
	Introduction to Philosophy of the Arts	Fall 2024
	Teaching Assistant at University of Texas at Austin	
	Introduction to Philosophy of the Arts (Matthew Bisconti)	Spring 2024
	Intermediate Symbolic Logic (Joshua Dever)	Fall 2024
	Introduction to Philosophy of the Arts (Kathleen Higgins)	Spring 2023
	Problems of Knowledge and Valuation (Mark Sainsbury)	Fall 2022
	Introduction to Philosophy of the Arts (Alicia Armijo)	Spring 2022
	Philosophy of Law (Jeffrey Leon)	Summer 2022
	Ideas of the Twentieth Century (Daniel Bonevac)	Fall 2021
SELECTED COURSEWORK	Graduate Seminars at University of Texas at Austin	
	Higher-Order Metaphysics (with Jon Litland and Harvey Lederman)	Fall 2025
	Issues in Philosophy of Music (with Kathleen Higgins)	Spring 2024
	Plenitude and Generation (with Jon Litland)	Fall 2023
	Artworks and Persons (with Robbie Kubala)	Fall 2023
	MSDRT Model Theory (with Hans Kamp)	Summer 2023
	Formal Epistemology (with Harvey Lederman)	Spring 2023
	Theories of Meaning (with Joshua Dever)	Spring 2023
	Kant's <i>Critique of Pure Reason</i> (with Ian Proops)	Spring 2023
	Logic and Inferentialism (with Jon Litland and Sinan Dogramaci)	Fall 2022
	<i>De Se</i> and the Self (with Joshua Dever and Miriam Schoenfield)	Fall 2022
	Perception and Action (with Galen Strawson)	Spring 2022
	Aesthetics (with Kathleen Higgins)	Fall 2021
	Metaethics and Aesthetics (with Karl Schafer and Robbie Kubala)	Fall 2021
	Conference Courses at University of Texas at Austin	
	Musical Structuralism and Category Theory (with Jon Litland)	Fall 2023
	Music and Meaning (with Kathleen Higgins)	Spring 2023

	Undergraduate Seminars at University of Wisconsin-Madison	
	Music, Capitalism, and Speculative Future (with Nadia Chana)	Spring 2021
	Renaissance Polyphony (with Leslie Blasius)	Spring 2021
	Orchestration (with Laura Schwendinger)	Spring 2021
	Form and Analysis (with Leslie Blasius)	Spring-Fall 2020
	Schopenhauer and Nietzsche (with James Messina)	Spring 2020
	Existentialism (with Henry Southgate)	Fall 2019
PROFESSIONAL SERVICE	Referee	2026
	<i>The British Journal of Aesthetics</i>	
	Program Committee	2022 – 2023
	Faculty Colloquium at University of Texas at Austin	
	Conference Organizer, Peer Reviewer	2023
	Graduate Conference at University of Texas at Austin	
PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS	American Society for Aesthetics	2023 – Present
	American Philosophical Association	2023 – Present
LANGUAGES	Mandarin (native), English (fluent)	
REFERENCES	Kathleen M. Higgins	Jon E. Litland
	Professor of Philosophy	Associate Professor of Philosophy
	University of Texas at Austin	University of Texas at Austin
	kmhiggins@austin.utexas.edu	jon.litland@utexas.edu
	Robbie Kubala	Joshua Dever
	Associate Professor of Philosophy	Professor of Philosophy
	University of Texas at Austin	University of Texas at Austin
	rkubala@gmail.com	dever@austin.utexas.edu
	Andrew Kania	Nicole Smith (Teaching)
	Professor of Philosophy	Associate Professor of Instruction
	Trinity University	University of Texas at Austin
	akania@trinity.edu	nasmith@austin.utexas.edu